Part 4 · Diagnose & Grow

Scoring a test is only step one. The real gains come from seeing **which skills need work** and studying those next. Use these pages after every practice test.

Score-Tracking Sheet

After each test, count the questions you answered correctly and write it here. Watch your scores climb from Test 1 to Test 4.

Test	Date	Points Earned	Out Of	Estimated Level
Math 1			~48	
Math 2			~48	
Math 3			~48	
Math 4			~48	
RLA 1			~56	
RLA 2			~56	
RLA 3			~56	
RLA 4			~56	

If you earned about…	Estimated level
Less than ~35%	Did Not Meet Grade Level
~35%–55%	Approaches Grade Level
~55%–80%	Meets Grade Level
~80% or more	Masters Grade Level

Important: The State of Texas sets the official passing scores each year, and they change. These percentages are a **rough guide** to track progress, not an official score. Aim for **Meets** or higher.

Strand Diagnostic Chart

For each test, count how many you got right in each strand or section. A low percentage points you straight to the lesson to review.

Mathematics strand	Qs / test	If low, review…
1 · Numerical Representations & Relationships	~4	Strand 1 lesson
2 · Computations & Algebraic Relationships	~15	Strand 2 lesson
3 · Geometry & Measurement	~13	Strand 3 lesson
4 · Data Analysis & Personal Financial Literacy	~8	Strand 4 lesson

RLA skill area	If low, review…
Vocabulary (context clues, roots)	Reading Lessons, Part A
Comprehension & inference	Reading Lessons, Part B
Using text evidence / summarizing	Reading Lessons, Part C
Literary elements	Reading Lessons, Part D
Author's purpose & craft	Reading Lessons, Part E
Revising & Editing	Revising & Editing Refresher
Short / Extended responses	SCR & ECR Mastery

How to use it: After each test, find your **weakest** row, reread that lesson, redo its "Try It" items, then try the next practice test. This is the fastest way to raise your score.

A Guide for Parents and Teachers

This book is built so a student can use it alone, but your support makes it far more powerful.

Start With the Diagnostics

The **Score-Tracking Sheet** and **Strand Diagnostic Chart** turn each test into a study plan. After a test, help the student find the weakest strand or skill area and go back to that lesson first. Watch for scores rising across Tests 1–4.

Coaching the Written Responses

The SCR and ECR are where many students leave points on the table. You do not need to grade like the state; instead, ask three questions:

1. **Did you answer the exact question?**
2. **Did you use specific evidence from the text?**
3. **Did you explain how the evidence supports your point?**

Compare the student's writing to the **scored samples** in this book. Seeing the difference between a high and a middle response teaches more than a grade ever could.

Keep It Positive and Steady

- Short, regular practice beats long, rare cram sessions. Use the 4-week or 8-week calendar.
- Praise **effort and strategy** ("You used two pieces of evidence!"), not just the score.
- Normalize mistakes—every wrong answer with a good explanation is a lesson learned.

On Test Day

Remind the student of the **Test-Day Game Plan**: read directions carefully, answer easy questions first, never leave a blank, and give the written responses real effort.

> **A note on the 2027 test:** Spring 2027 is the final STAAR administration for grades 3–8. Whatever assessment follows, the skills in this book—reading closely, reasoning with evidence, solving real-world math—will continue to serve your student well.

TEKS Coverage Index

Every eligible Grade 8 Math and RLA student expectation, and where each is **taught** and **practiced**. ★ = Readiness, ○ = Supporting. Nothing outside these standards appears in the book, and nothing is left out.

Mathematics

TEKS	Skill	R/S	Taught	Practiced
8.2A	Sets of real numbers	○	Strand 1	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.2B	Approximate irrationals	○	Strand 1	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.2C	Scientific notation	○	Strand 1	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.2D	Order real numbers	★	Strand 1	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.4A	Slope via similar triangles	○	Strand 2	Tests 1–4
8.4B	Graph proportional; unit rate	★	Strand 2	Tests 1–4
8.4C	Rate of change & y-intercept	★	Strand 2	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.5A/B/E/F/H	Proportional / non-proportional, functions	○	Strand 2	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.5G	Identify functions	★	Strand 2	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.5I	Write y = mx + b	★	Strand 2	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.8A/B	Write equations / problems	○	Strand 2	Tests 1–4
8.8C	Solve equations, both sides	★	Strand 2	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.9A	Simultaneous linear (intersection)	○	Strand 2	Tests 1–4
8.3A/B	Similar shapes, dilations	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.3C	Dilation by scale factor	★	Strand 3	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.6A/C	Cylinder volume; Pythagorean model	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.7A	Volume: cylinders, cones, spheres	★	Strand 3	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.7B	Surface area	★	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.7C	Pythagorean theorem & converse	★	Strand 3	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.7D	Distance between two points	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.8D	Angle relationships, AA	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.10A/B	Transformations & congruence	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.10C	Translations, reflections, rotations	★	Strand 3	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.10D	Dilation effect on measurement	○	Strand 3	Tests 1–4
8.5C	Bivariate data: linear vs. not	○	Strand 4	Tests 1–4
8.5D	Trend line predictions	★	Strand 4	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.11A	Scatterplot & association	○	Strand 4	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.11B	Mean absolute deviation	○	Strand 4	Tests 1–4, Drills
8.12A/C/G	Cost of credit, saving, college plan	○	Strand 4	Tests 1–4
8.12D	Simple vs. compound interest	★	Strand 4	Tests 1–4, Drills

8.1 A–G	Mathematical process standards	—	Process Standards	Woven through all items

Reading Language Arts

TEKS	Skill	R/S	Taught	Practiced
2A/2C	Reference tools; Greek/Latin roots	○	Reading A	RLA Tests 1–4
2B	Context clues	★	Reading A	RLA Tests 1–4
5C/5E	Predictions; connections	○/★	Reading B	Reading lessons
5F	Inference + evidence	★	Reading B	RLA Tests 1–4
5G	Key ideas / central idea	★	Reading B	RLA Tests 1–4
5H	Synthesize	★	Reading B	RLA Tests 1–4
6B	Compare sources	★	ECR Mastery	Paired sets + ECR
6C	Text evidence	★	Reading C	Tests 1–4, SCR
6D	Paraphrase & summarize	★	Reading C	RLA Tests 1–4
7A/7D	Theme; setting	○	Reading D	RLA Tests 1–4
7B	Character motivation	★	Reading D	RLA Tests 1–4
7C	Non-linear plot	★	Reading D	RLA Test 1
8A	Literary genres	○	Genre Guide	RLA Test 4
8B	Poetry: graphical elements	○	Genre Guide	RLA Tests 1, 3
8C	Drama: acts/scenes	○	Genre Guide	RLA Test 2
8D	Informational: thesis, features	★/○	Genre Guide	RLA Tests 1–4
8E	Argumentative: claim, counter, audience	★/○	Genre Guide	RLA Tests 2, 4
9A	Author's purpose & message	★	Reading E	RLA Tests 1–4
9B/9C	Text structure; print/graphic features	○	Reading E	RLA Tests 1–4
9D/9E/9F/9G	Figurative language, devices, tone, rhetoric	○	Reading E	RLA Tests 1–4
10B/10C	Composition: structure, revise	★	Revising/Editing	RLA Tests 1–4
10D·i/ii/vii	Sentences, verb tense, spelling	★	Revising/Editing	RLA Tests 1–4
10D·iii–vi	Prepositions, pronoun, caps, punctuation	○	Revising/Editing	RLA Tests 1–4
11B	Compose informational	★	ECR Mastery	RLA Tests 2, 4 (ECR)
11C	Compose argumentative	★	ECR Mastery	RLA Tests 1, 3 (ECR)
11D	Compose correspondence	○	ECR Mastery	Revising/Editing

Coverage guarantee: Every eligible Grade 8 Math and RLA TEKS is both taught and practiced in this book, and no content outside the eligible TEKS is included.

Final Notes

You Are Ready

If you have worked through the lessons, taken the practice tests, reviewed the explanations, and used the diagnostic charts, you have done the hard, honest work that builds real confidence. You have practiced every skill the STAAR Grade 8 Reading Language Arts and Mathematics tests can ask of you—reading closely, reasoning with evidence, and solving real problems.

On test day, trust your preparation. Read carefully, answer every question, give the written responses your best effort, and use your full time. You've got this.

A Word About What Comes Next

Spring 2027 is the final STAAR administration for grades 3–8. A new Texas assessment will follow, but the skills you have strengthened here do not expire. Strong readers and problem-solvers succeed on any test—and far beyond it.

About the Series

This **2027 Edition** is part of a Grade-by-Grade Texas test-preparation series created to give students clear teaching, realistic practice, and honest feedback—100% aligned to the Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills, with nothing wasted.

Author: Adrian Ross

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Content reflects the STAAR program as of **November 5, 2026**. Test specifications can change; confirm current details at the official Texas Education Agency website.